scriptural testimony only, but, contrary to the belief of other schools, adds that such a reliable person may be a sage, any ordinary person, or, in fact, anyone. It is further held that it is not at all necessary that such a person should be completely free from moral defects. What is needed is that he should have no motive to give incorrect information—a fact which accords completely with our modern attitude toward authority or the testimony of experts. Testimony is further subdivided into two kinds: *viz.,* testimony based upon things perceived, and testimony based upon things heard and inferred though not seen. A man may, for instance, speak of what he has himself seen, or he may speak of what he has heard or inferred. Either of these could be an equally valid source of knowledge to others.

Now, with regard to authority as a valid source of knowledge, two questions can be raised immediately. First, "Should authority be accepted at all as a valid source of knowledge?" and, second, "If accepted, what should be its place in relation to other means of knowledge?" Is it just like any other source of information giving valid knowledge, or does it enjoy a greater authoritativeness and a place of privilege over perception, inference, and the rest? As to the latter, it is maintained that there is no such thing as a higher and lower validity of knowledge, for the idea of quantity is not admissible in the concept of validity as such. What distinguishes the different means of valid knowledge such as perception, inference, and authority from one another is not their higher or lower validity but the nature and kind of facts and objects which they reveal. Perceptual knowledge, e.g., reveals the externally and sensuously perceptible world; inference employs a non-sensuous process and applies it to the abstract and the remote, and authority helps us to cognize what cannot be known by either of the other sources of knowledge. Any one of these could be equally valid or invalid in its own sphere, and there is no point in saying that one is more valid than the other. That testimony is supposed to reveal knowledge of facts like *dharma, mokṣa,* etc., which are in themselves considered to be of more importance to man than knowledge of facts about the sensible world, or that the scriptures are supposed to contain knowledge which is considered to have been acquired by minds higher than our own, is, however, quite another matter. Here, one may ask, is it not a fact that in Indian philosophy a man's reasoning and conclusions are *ipso facto* invalidated if they are not in agreement with the authority of the Veda and the Upaniṣads—called *śruti?* Does this not undermine the independent validity of other sources of knowledge like infer-